

Pretext Typography Discussion

Wednesday, April 8, 2026

Participants: User, Assistant

How does Pretext handle text measurement?

5:00 AM

Pretext uses a two-phase approach: `prepare()` segments the text and measures each segment via Canvas, caching widths. Then `layout()` walks the cached widths with pure arithmetic to count lines and compute height. This is ~ 0.0002ms per text block.

5:00 AM

What about variable fonts?

5:01 AM

Variable fonts work through CSS font strings passed to `prepare()`. For example, '700 16px Fraunces' will measure using weight 700 of the Fraunces variable font. The Canvas API resolves variation axes automatically.

5:01 AM